

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Office and Administrative Assistant English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Office assistants, administrative assistants, reception administrators, and team support staff.

All organizations, appointments, documents, prices, policies, and incidents are fictional English practice. This is not legal, financial, immigration, security, or records-retention advice. Follow the employer's actual purchasing, access, privacy, travel, and approval arrangements. Sample policies and delegated responsibilities apply only to the stated exercise.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Scheduling across calendars and time zones

Confirm whose clock a proposed meeting time refers to.

02 Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

Request purpose, reference, and contact information without promising a callback time.

03 Preparing meetings and confirming action points

Help participants confirm a task, owner, and deadline.

04 Checking document versions and access

Repair a version error without assuming a link works for everyone.

05 Querying office supplies and delivery differences

Give order, stated quantity, received quantity, and the response needed.

06 Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

Use the appointment reference to identify the right receiving colleague.

07 Clarifying travel options and booking status

Explain price and cancellation flexibility using the supplied terms.

08 Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

Negotiate task order using actual durations and agreed deadlines.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Scheduling across calendars and time zones

Confirm whose clock a proposed meeting time refers to.

SITUATION

A colleague asks for a 3:00 meeting with another office. For this fictional date, 3:00 in the colleague's office equals noon at the other office. The request does not identify whose time is intended. Both calendars are open at that equivalent time; confirm the intended time before sending invitations.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

calendar invitation - An electronic request placing a proposed meeting in participants' calendars.

tentative hold - A temporary reservation of time that has not yet been fully confirmed.

time zone - A region's system of local clock time used when comparing meeting times across locations.

buffer time - Time left between appointments for preparation, travel, or overruns.

Useful word combinations

place a tentative hold: reserve a proposed time without calling it confirmed

check for a conflict: identify appointments that overlap

allow a buffer: leave time between scheduled commitments

confirm the time zone: state which local clock time an invitation uses

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Resolve the time reference before booking

3. Notice the language

A calendar opening is not acceptance. State both local times for the supplied date and distinguish a hold from a confirmed meeting.

Do you mean ___ in ___ time?

On that date, it will be ___ for ___.

I've placed a hold; ___ is still unconfirmed.

Compare this wording: I'll book three.

Clearer: Do you mean three here, which is noon for the other office on that date?

The question identifies the missing time reference.

4. Check the language

1. Colleague: I mean three in our office, which is noon there on this date.

Assistant: I'll show ___ on the invitation.

A. three in both offices

B. noon in both offices

C. an unspecified afternoon time

D. both local times

2. Colleague: You reserved the time, but Morgan hasn't replied. Is the meeting confirmed?

Assistant: No, the calendar entry is ___.

A. a confirmed appointment

B. a declined invitation

C. a tentative hold

D. an accepted invitation

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Whose three o'clock?

An assistant checks a meeting request before sending invitations.

01 • Assistant: You asked for three o'clock. Which office's time zone did you mean for this meeting?

02 • Colleague: Three here, please. I hadn't realized my message left that detail open for you.

03 • Assistant: For this date, that's noon in their office. Both calendars show an opening then.

04 • Colleague: Good. Could you reserve half an hour and include both local times in the invitation?

05 • Assistant: Yes. Is this a confirmed meeting, or should I place a tentative hold while you ask Dana?

06 • Colleague: A tentative hold. Dana still needs to agree, even though the calendar looks free.

07 • Assistant: I'll mark it tentative and wait for your confirmation before describing it as accepted.

08 • Colleague: Please allow fifteen minutes afterward as buffer time before my next call as well.

09 • Assistant: The calendar permits that. I've held thirty minutes plus the separate fifteen-minute buffer.

10 • Colleague: Thanks. I'll ask Dana today and tell you whether to confirm or release the hold.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Back-to-back meetings leave no travel time

An assistant flags a scheduling conflict.

01 • Assistant: Your client meeting ends at two, and the next appointment starts across town at two.

02 • Manager: I didn't notice the locations. That would leave no travel time between those appointments.

03 • Assistant: The second host offered two-thirty as an alternative. Would you like me to check that slot?

04 • Manager: Yes, but ask about the meeting length before moving anything already in the calendar.

05 • Assistant: It's a thirty-minute discussion, and their two-thirty opening is still available this afternoon.

06 • Manager: Then move the second appointment to two-thirty and keep the first one unchanged.

07 • Assistant: I'll send the revised invitation and identify the location so nobody expects a video call.

08 • Manager: Please ask the host to acknowledge the change rather than assume they saw the calendar update.

09 • Assistant: They've accepted two-thirty at their office. Your first meeting still ends here at two.

10 • Manager: Good. That leaves the agreed travel buffer, and I can prepare for the correct location.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

One occurrence, not the whole series

An assistant clarifies a recurring-meeting change.

01 • Assistant: You asked to move next Tuesday's team call. Should the later weekly meetings stay unchanged?

02 • Colleague: Yes. Only next Tuesday needs moving because the visitor presentation overlaps with it.

03 • Assistant: The recurring series is at ten. Do you want that one occurrence at eleven instead?

04 • Colleague: Eleven works, and the usual thirty-minute length can stay the same for that date.

05 • Assistant: I'll change the individual occurrence, not every future invitation in the series.

06 • Colleague: Please make that clear in the update, because people may assume our weekly schedule has changed.

07 • Assistant: The message will name the specific Tuesday date and confirm later weeks remain at ten.

08 • Colleague: Can you also leave the original video link in place if the meeting system allows it?

09 • Assistant: The updated invitation retains that link. I've checked the revised date and time before sending.

10 • Colleague: I've received it. Only next Tuesday now shows eleven; the following week still shows ten.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Scheduling across calendars and time zones

A colleague asks for a 3:00 meeting with another office. For this fictional date, 3:00 in the colleague's office equals noon at the other office. The request does not identify whose time is intended. Both calendars are open at that equivalent time; confirm the intended time before sending invitations.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Colleague: mean three in your own office; can explain the supplied noon equivalent when asked.

Second round: One participant calls the time lunchtime. Check their local time rather than treating the phrase as a new booking request.

Scenario 2 | An all-day hold hides an available hour

A calendar shows an all-day tentative planning hold. The owner can release 1:00-2:00 for a supplier call but wants the rest kept. The supplier has not accepted.

Role A: Assistant: clarify the partial release and keep supplier acceptance pending.

Role B: Calendar owner: authorize only the one-hour release.

Possible opening: Can you clear that planning hold so I can speak to the supplier?

Success checks

- Name the released hour.
- Keep the rest of the hold intact.
- Distinguish available time from supplier acceptance.

Add a complication: A colleague assumes the entire day is now free.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

Request purpose, reference, and contact information without promising a callback time.

SITUATION

Caller Lena Park needs the facilities team about delivery D18, not the finance team about an invoice. Facilities extension is 214. Lena requests a callback before 4:00, but availability is unknown. Ask for the delivery reference and preferred contact route, then relay the requested deadline without promising it.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

extension - An internal telephone number used to reach a person or department within an organization.

callback - A return telephone call responding to an earlier call or message.

message routing - Directing a telephone message to the person or team responsible for its subject.

direct line - A telephone number that reaches a particular person or team without going through the main reception number.

Useful word combinations

take a message: record the caller's relevant details

read the number back: repeat a phone number to check accuracy

put a caller through: connect them to the intended recipient

confirm the purpose of the call: ask what the caller needs without requesting unnecessary private details

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Collect the details needed for the right recipient

3. Notice the language

A caller's requested deadline is not a colleague's commitment. Read back ambiguous names or numbers and keep the message focused.

Is this about ___ or ___?

Let me read that reference back: ___.

You've requested a callback by ___; I'll pass that on.

Compare this wording: Someone will call before four.

Clearer: I'll pass on your request for a callback before four; the team hasn't confirmed that time.

The caller's preference remains distinct from a promise.

4. Check the language

1. Caller: This is about the delivery, not its invoice.

Assistant: I'll route your message to ____.

A. the payments callback list

B. the invoice approvals desk

C. facilities at extension 214

D. finance for an invoice check

2. Caller: Can they call before four?

Assistant: I'll pass on your ____ for that time.

A. accepted appointment

B. request

C. confirmation

D. completed callback

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Delivery, not invoice payment

An assistant routes a supplier's call.

01 • Assistant: Is your question about the invoice or the physical delivery, so I can reach the right team?

02 • Caller: The delivery. I'm Lena Park, and our reference is D18. We need unloading arrangements.

03 • Assistant: Facilities handles that at extension 214. Would you prefer a transfer or a callback request?

04 • Caller: A callback, please. I need an answer before four if someone is available then.

05 • Assistant: I'll include that requested time. I haven't confirmed the team's availability for a return call.

06 • Caller: They have our office number from yesterday. Could you ask them to use that number again?

07 • Assistant: I'll check the stored business contact rather than copy a number from a different supplier.

08 • Caller: Please read the reference back as well; people sometimes hear B instead of D.

09 • Assistant: D18, with D as in Delta, for facilities about unloading arrangements before four if possible.

10 • Caller: That's correct. Please route it to facilities, not the accounts colleague I spoke to yesterday.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A similar surname needs spelling

An assistant checks the intended recipient of a call.

01 • Assistant: Did you ask for Morgan Lee or Morgan Leigh? Both work in this building.

02 • Caller: Morgan Leigh, ending G-H. We discussed next week's training room booking yesterday afternoon.

03 • Assistant: Thank you. That Morgan is in learning support, on extension 306, rather than sales.

04 • Caller: Yes, learning support is right. Could you put me through to that extension now?

05 • Assistant: I can try. Would you like to leave a message if the extension isn't answered?

06 • Caller: Yes. Please say the revised attendance count is eighteen, not the sixteen I gave yesterday.

07 • Assistant: I'll pass on the changed count if needed. Is there a reference Morgan will recognize?

08 • Caller: Training T52. You don't need the attendees' individual names for this particular message.

09 • Assistant: Understood. Morgan Leigh, learning support, T52, revised count eighteen. I'll connect you now.

10 • Caller: Thank you for checking the spelling; the wrong Morgan wouldn't know anything about the room.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A direct line is not a personal number

An assistant responds to an external caller.

01 • Assistant: I can offer the team's published direct line or take a message for the colleague.

02 • Caller: I was hoping for their personal mobile number so I could reach them this evening.

03 • Assistant: I can't share a private number. The published direct line is the available business contact.

04 • Caller: That's fine. Does calling the direct line guarantee they will answer rather than the team?

05 • Assistant: No, it reaches their team contact point; I can't promise who will be available.

06 • Caller: Then please take a message. I want to confirm the room booking reference A17.

07 • Assistant: Certainly. I'll include A17 and your request for confirmation, without adding any private details.

08 • Caller: Can you note that email is easier for me than another phone call today?

09 • Assistant: Yes, I'll use the business email address already recorded for this booking and note that preference.

10 • Caller: Thanks. A reply through that address will be enough; I don't need the personal number.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

Caller Lena Park needs the facilities team about delivery D18, not the finance team about an invoice. Facilities extension is 214. Lena requests a callback before 4:00, but availability is unknown. Ask for the delivery reference and preferred contact route, then relay the requested deadline without promising it.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Caller: Lena Park, reference D18, want facilities and a reply before four; can give a work callback number orally.

Second round: The caller says they already spoke to accounts. Confirm whether the current question is still about physical delivery.

Scenario 2 | A callback number was heard incorrectly

A caller gives a fictional number ending 0614, but the assistant repeats 0641. The caller needs a room-booking response before Friday; no callback time is agreed.

Role A: Assistant: invite and acknowledge the correction.

Role B: Caller: correct the final four digits and confirm the Friday need.

Possible opening: The last four digits are zero-six-one-four, not zero-six-four-one.

Success checks

- Read back the corrected digits.
- State the room-booking purpose.
- Label Friday as requested rather than confirmed.

Add a complication: The caller interprets repeating Friday as a guaranteed callback deadline.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Preparing meetings and confirming action points

Help participants confirm a task, owner, and deadline.

SITUATION

A meeting has ten minutes left and two agenda items: printer replacement and visitor signage. The chair prioritizes the printer decision. Sam can obtain two quotes by Thursday; nobody has approved a purchase. Ask the group to confirm that action and defer signage to the next meeting.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

agenda - A list of topics and their planned order for a meeting.

attendee - A person expected to participate in a meeting or event.

minutes - A record of a meeting's key decisions and actions, not necessarily a word-for-word transcript.

action item - A specific task agreed at a meeting, ideally with an owner and due date.

Useful word combinations

circulate the agenda: share the planned meeting topics with attendees

confirm the action owner: identify who has agreed to carry out a task

capture the decision: record what the meeting actually agreed

defer an item: move a topic to a later discussion

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Close a discussion with a specific action

3. Notice the language

Distinguish discussion, action, and decision. Obtaining quotes is not the same as approving an order.

Who will take ___, and by when?

The agreed action is ___; no decision on ___ yet.

Can we defer ___ until ___?

Compare this wording: Sam will sort out the printer.

Clearer: Sam will obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase is approved.

The record states a checkable task and avoids inventing a decision.

4. Check the language

1. Chair: We only agreed to obtain prices.

Assistant: The minutes should record ____.

A. equipment replacement delivered

B. two quotes requested, purchase undecided

C. printer purchase approved

D. supplier appointment completed

2. Chair: Sam may send the quotes early, but Thursday is the deadline.

Assistant: Sam will obtain two quotes ____ Thursday.

A. by

B. until

C. since

D. from

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Quotes are an action, not an order

An assistant helps close a short office meeting.

01 • Assistant: We have ten minutes left and two agenda items. Which should we finish today?

02 • Chair: The printer decision needs attention first. Visitor signage can go on the next agenda.

03 • Assistant: Sam offered to get two quotes by Thursday. Shall I confirm that as the action item?

04 • Chair: Yes. Sam has accepted it, but we haven't approved buying a printer from either supplier.

05 • Assistant: I'll record Sam as the owner and Thursday as the deadline for those two quotes.

06 • Chair: Please don't call it a purchase decision in the minutes; we still need the comparison.

07 • Assistant: Understood. Does the signage item need an interim action before the next meeting?

08 • Chair: No. The current signs remain in place, and the review can wait until next Tuesday.

09 • Assistant: Then the open purchase decision stays open, and signage is scheduled for Tuesday's agenda.

10 • Chair: That's agreed. Please read those two points back to the attendees before we finish.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An action needs a person, not a department name

An assistant checks a meeting note with a colleague.

01 • Assistant: My note says operations will check the room equipment. Who accepted that action during the meeting?

02 • Colleague: I did. Please put my name, Mira, rather than leave it assigned to the whole department.

03 • Assistant: What did you agree to check, and was there a deadline for reporting back?

04 • Colleague: The screen connection and remote microphone, by Wednesday at noon, before Thursday's training session.

05 • Assistant: I'll record both items and that deadline. Was fixing any fault also assigned to you?

06 • Colleague: No. I'll report what works and raise any fault with support; I haven't promised repairs myself.

07 • Assistant: Thanks. That gives the minutes a clear action without extending your responsibility beyond the discussion.

08 • Colleague: Could you read the wording back? I want to make sure the deadline concerns my report.

09 • Assistant: Mira checks the screen connection and microphone and reports the results by Wednesday noon.

10 • Colleague: That matches. If there's a fault, the support request will be a separate follow-up.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A missing agenda attachment

An assistant helps an attendee find the meeting information.

01 • Assistant: You received the calendar invitation, but said the agenda wasn't attached. Is the meeting time visible?

02 • Attendee: Yes, Tuesday at ten is clear. I just don't know which topics need preparation.

03 • Assistant: The agenda is in the shared meeting folder. I should have included the link.

04 • Attendee: Could you send that link rather than another attachment that might become an older copy?

05 • Assistant: Certainly. The current agenda has three items, and your presentation is the second one.

06 • Attendee: How much time is allocated to it? I need to keep the example within the meeting limit.

07 • Assistant: Ten minutes for the presentation and five for questions, according to the current agenda.

08 • Attendee: That gives me fifteen in total. I'll plan the presentation for ten, not use all fifteen.

09 • Assistant: I've sent the folder link. Please check that you can open it before the meeting.

10 • Attendee: It opens now. I'll prepare ten minutes of presentation for the second agenda item.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Preparing meetings and confirming action points

A meeting has ten minutes left and two agenda items: printer replacement and visitor signage. The chair prioritizes the printer decision. Sam can obtain two quotes by Thursday; nobody has approved a purchase. Ask the group to confirm that action and defer signage to the next meeting.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Chair: prioritize the printer; confirm Sam can obtain two quotes by Thursday; signage can wait unless someone raises a concrete urgency.

Second round: An attendee says the minutes should list a printer purchase. Clarify the actual decision before ending.

Scenario 2 | A meeting ends without a deadline

The team agrees that Leon will compare two room-booking systems, but no date is stated. Leon can provide a comparison Friday; the chair needs it Thursday and can accept an initial summary then.

Role A: Assistant: invite a feasible deadline and distinguish summary from full comparison.

Role B: Leon: offer Thursday's summary and Friday's full comparison.

Possible opening: Before we finish, when should Leon bring back the comparison?

Success checks

- Name Leon as owner.
- Confirm two distinct deliverables and dates.
- Read back the agreed action aloud.

Add a complication: An attendee assumes Thursday means the complete comparison.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Checking document versions and access

Repair a version error without assuming a link works for everyone.

SITUATION

An assistant sent version 2 of a visitor guide, but version 3 was approved this morning. The older version has the wrong reception floor. The current guide is in the shared folder; one recipient lacks viewing access. Correct the message and request access from the document owner without widening permissions independently.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

version - An identifiable revision of a document or file.

attachment - A file sent with an email or message.

shared folder - A storage location accessible to designated people for common files.

access permission - A setting determining whether a person may view, edit, or otherwise use a file or location.

Useful word combinations

confirm the current version: identify which revision should be used

check the attachment: verify which file was actually sent

request viewing access: ask for permission to read without implying editing rights

replace an outdated link: provide a link to the intended current document

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Correct the file and the recipient's usable access

3. Notice the language

State the current revision and the consequential difference. A correct link is not useful until the intended recipient can open it.

I sent version ____; the current version is ____.

The corrected detail is ____.

Can you confirm you can view ____?

Compare this wording: The file is somewhere in the folder.

Clearer: Version three is current; I'll send its link and check your viewing access.

The recipient knows which file to use and what remains unresolved.

4. Check the language

1. Recipient: I have the link, but it says access denied.

Assistant: The unresolved issue is your ____.

A. access permission

B. document revision

C. file format

D. attachment size

2. Recipient: Which guide should I use now?

Assistant: Use ____ once your viewing access is confirmed.

A. the version two attachment

B. whichever copy was downloaded first

C. the oldest saved copy

D. approved version three

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correct guide, blocked link

An assistant corrects an outdated visitor-guide attachment.

01 • Assistant: I sent version two earlier. Version three was approved this morning and corrects the reception floor.

02 • Recipient: That explains the difference from the invitation. Which file should I use for tomorrow's visit?

03 • Assistant: Version three in the shared folder. I'm sorry the earlier attachment gave the wrong floor.

04 • Recipient: I've opened your new link, but I get an access-denied message rather than the guide.

05 • Assistant: I'll ask the document owner to grant the viewing access you need for that file.

06 • Recipient: Please don't make the whole folder public just for me; I only need the visitor guide.

07 • Assistant: Agreed. I've requested access to that document. The owner has now confirmed the permission change.

08 • Recipient: Let me try again. It opens, and version three says reception is on the second floor.

09 • Assistant: That's the current information. Please use that link rather than the older downloaded attachment.

10 • Recipient: I've marked the downloaded copy as old. I'll use this link tomorrow.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

View access is enough for the task

An assistant clarifies a colleague's file-access request.

01 • Assistant: You asked for access to the supplier schedule. Do you need to read it or update entries?

02 • Colleague: Only read it. I'm checking the arrival times before I prepare the room list.

03 • Assistant: Then viewing access is enough. I'll ask the document owner for it.

04 • Colleague: I don't need edit rights, and I don't want to change anything accidentally while checking.

05 • Assistant: Your access permission is view-only. The owner has sent the current file; can you open it?

06 • Colleague: It opens now. I can see the Tuesday delivery but can't type in the cells.

07 • Assistant: That's expected for viewing access. If you find an error, send it to the schedule owner.

08 • Colleague: The room number on one line may be wrong. I'll ask the owner to confirm it.

09 • Assistant: Please quote the delivery reference so they can find the exact entry you're questioning.

10 • Colleague: I'll quote D43 and Tuesday's date when I ask the owner about that room.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An attachment name conceals an older revision

An assistant checks two similarly named files with a colleague.

01 • Assistant: Both attachments are called final agenda, but their revision dates differ. Which one did the chair approve?

02 • Colleague: The one revised at eleven today. The earlier file still has the old speaker order.

03 • Assistant: I'll use the timestamp and the approved shared-folder copy, not the filename final by itself.

04 • Colleague: Could you check that the opening speaker is Rosa before you send the agenda to attendees?

05 • Assistant: The current approved copy lists Rosa first and Daniel second. That matches the chair's message.

06 • Colleague: Good. Please send the link so people don't keep editing separate copies from their inboxes.

07 • Assistant: I'll do that. What should I tell someone who already downloaded the earlier attachment?

08 • Colleague: Ask them to use the current link; don't assume their downloaded copy updates automatically afterward.

09 • Assistant: The message now names the eleven o'clock revision and explains that the speaker order changed.

10 • Colleague: That's enough. Everyone can check the same current agenda before tomorrow's meeting starts.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Checking document versions and access

An assistant sent version 2 of a visitor guide, but version 3 was approved this morning. The older version has the wrong reception floor. The current guide is in the shared folder; one recipient lacks viewing access. Correct the message and request access from the document owner without widening permissions independently.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Recipient: have version two and a denied-access message on the new link; need the correct reception floor.

Second round: The recipient asks you to make the whole folder public. Request the necessary limited access from its owner instead.

Scenario 2 | A link opens the template, not the completed document

A colleague sends a blank visitor-list template instead of the completed list for Thursday. The completed version is in a restricted shared folder. The requester already has viewing permission there.

Role A: Assistant: identify the wrong file type and send the correct existing link.

Role B: Requester: need Thursday's completed list, not a new template.

Possible opening: This opens a blank form; where are Thursday's attendees?

Success checks

- Identify the completed Thursday list.
- Keep the template separate.
- Confirm the requester can view the corrected link without changing permissions.

Add a complication: The sender assumes the requester wants to edit the template.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Querying office supplies and delivery differences

Give order, stated quantity, received quantity, and the response needed.

SITUATION

Purchase order P44 is for twelve archive boxes. The delivery note lists twelve, but the checked shipment contains ten. No second package or backorder is documented. Ask the supplier to confirm the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned; do not approve payment or claim theft.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

requisition - An internal request for goods or services before any required purchasing approval.

purchase order - A document issued by an organization specifying an order for goods or services.

delivery note - A document listing the goods a supplier states are included in a delivery.

backorder - An ordered item not currently supplied that remains due for later fulfillment.

Useful word combinations

match the delivery to the order: compare received items with the stated request

report a short delivery: notify the supplier that fewer items arrived than expected

ask for a revised delivery date: request an updated arrival estimate

confirm the outstanding quantity: state how many ordered items remain undelivered

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Ask a supplier about a specific mismatch

3. Notice the language

A document saying delivered does not establish the physical count. Ask about the two missing units without inventing their cause or arrival date.

The order lists ____; we received ____.

Could you confirm whether ____?

Please give us the next update by ____ if agreed.

Compare this wording: Our order is wrong.

Clearer: P44 lists twelve boxes, but the checked shipment contains ten; are two still due?

The supplier receives an identifiable discrepancy and a focused question.

4. Check the language

1. Colleague: Ten of twelve boxes arrived, but there's no notice about the other two. Are they confirmed as a backorder?

Assistant: ____.

A. We've received confirmation that both are on backorder

B. The delivery note confirms that another shipment is due

C. The physical count confirms that all twelve have arrived

D. We've reported a short delivery; a backorder hasn't been confirmed

2. Colleague: I submitted a requisition. Has that automatically placed the supplier order?

Assistant: No, it is still an ____.

A. acknowledged delivery

B. approved invoice

C. internal request

D. issued purchase order

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

An assistant calls a supplier about archive boxes.

01 • Assistant: I'm calling about purchase order P44. We ordered twelve archive boxes, but the shipment contains ten.

02 • Supplier: Our delivery note lists twelve. Have you checked whether two were packed in a separate package?

03 • Assistant: We've checked the received shipment and have no second package or backorder notice recorded.

04 • Supplier: Thank you. I'll ask dispatch to check the packing record for those two boxes.

05 • Assistant: Could you confirm whether another package is due and tell us when you'll update us?

06 • Supplier: I can give you an update at three today. I can't confirm another shipment yet.

07 • Assistant: Three is helpful. We need the missing boxes for Friday, but haven't promised their arrival internally.

08 • Supplier: I'll include that need in the query without changing the delivery date before dispatch responds.

09 • Assistant: Please use P44 in your reply so we can keep it with the delivery note.

10 • Supplier: I'll quote P44 when I call you at three with dispatch's update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An internal request has not reached the supplier

An assistant checks a colleague's supply request.

01 • Assistant: Your requisition for notebooks is in the internal approval queue. Have you received any purchasing confirmation?

02 • Colleague: No. I assumed submitting the form meant the supplier had already been asked to deliver.

03 • Assistant: Not yet. A purchase order hasn't been issued, so there isn't a confirmed supplier delivery date.

04 • Colleague: We need them Monday. Could you ask the approver to review the request today?

05 • Assistant: Yes. I'll add the Monday requirement and ask whether they can review it today.

06 • Colleague: Please tell the team we're still waiting for approval, not expecting a confirmed Monday delivery.

07 • Assistant: I will. I'll report the request status and any confirmed next step after the reviewer responds.

08 • Colleague: Could we check the supply cupboard in the meantime for enough notebooks for the first session?

09 • Assistant: There are six available. Would those cover the six attendees at Monday's opening session?

10 • Colleague: Yes. Six cover Monday's group. Please keep the purchase request active for later sessions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A backorder is not a new order

An assistant discusses an undelivered part of an existing purchase.

01 • Assistant: Your message says the remaining four folders are on backorder. Are they still part of P58?

02 • Supplier: Yes. Eight of the twelve were delivered; four remain outstanding under that same purchase order.

03 • Assistant: Then I don't need to place a second order for four simply to keep the request active?

04 • Supplier: Correct. A duplicate order could create another purchase. These four are still due on P58.

05 • Assistant: Do you have a confirmed delivery date, or only an estimate at this stage?

06 • Supplier: Only an estimate of next Thursday. We'll confirm once the shipment is actually arranged.

07 • Assistant: Please label that as estimated in the update. Our team is deciding whether to use existing folders.

08 • Supplier: I can do that. Would you also like notice if the estimate changes before dispatch?

09 • Assistant: Please notify purchasing if the estimate changes, and copy our office inbox.

10 • Supplier: Agreed. Four remain on backorder, with Thursday as an estimate. I'll contact purchasing.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Querying office supplies and delivery differences

Purchase order P44 is for twelve archive boxes. The delivery note lists twelve, but the checked shipment contains ten. No second package or backorder is documented. Ask the supplier to confirm the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned; do not approve payment or claim theft.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Supplier: order P44 shows twelve; can investigate the missing two and provide an update at three, but have no confirmed explanation yet.

Second round: The delivery note is signed. Keep the reported physical count separate from assumptions about what the signature proves.

Scenario 2 | The right quantity but the wrong size

Order S31 specifies six A4 storage trays. Six letter-size trays arrived. Ordered A4 trays: TR-A4; delivered letter-size trays: TR-LTR. The supplier can review an exchange but no collection date is confirmed.

Role A: Assistant: distinguish size mismatch from quantity shortage.

Role B: Supplier: ask for the item codes and offer a review update tomorrow morning.

Possible opening: We received six trays, but their size differs from S31.

Success checks

- Give the correct quantities and sizes.
- Keep exchange review separate from confirmed replacement.
- Avoid presenting a duplicate order as already required.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to reorder six before the supplier responds.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

Use the appointment reference to identify the right receiving colleague.

SITUATION

Visitor Taylor arrives for a 10:00 meeting with Jordan. The office has two Jordans: Jordan Chen in facilities and Jordan Patel in sales. Reference V12 names Jordan Chen. Check the reference, contact the host, and explain the reception wait; the visitor is not cleared to enter other areas alone.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

visitor log - A record of visitors' arrival and departure details kept under the organization's stated arrangements.

host - The employee responsible for receiving a particular visitor.

visitor badge - An identification pass issued for a visitor's permitted access.

appointment reference - A code or identifier linking a visitor to a particular scheduled visit.

Useful word combinations

confirm the host: identify the employee expecting the visitor

check the appointment reference: match the visit to its recorded booking

issue the visitor badge: provide the appropriate pass after the required check

wait in reception: remain in the visitor area until the receiving arrangements are confirmed

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Check identity of the host without unnecessary questions

3. Notice the language

A shared first name is not enough to route a visitor. Ask for the relevant reference rather than private details unrelated to the visit.

Could I check your appointment reference?

That lists ___ in ___.

Please wait here while I contact ___.

Compare this wording: Jordan is upstairs somewhere.

Clearer: V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities; I'll contact that host before directing you further.

The visitor gets a confirmed receiving person and a clear waiting location.

4. Check the language

1. Visitor: I'm here for Jordan, reference V12.

Assistant: Your host is ____.

A. either Jordan available first

B. the colleague with the nearest desk

C. Jordan Chen in facilities

D. Jordan Patel in sales

2. Visitor: This pass shows my name, today's date, and the word Visitor. Is it for me or my car?

Assistant: It's your ____ for this visit.

A. delivery authorization

B. visitor badge

C. employee access card

D. temporary parking permit

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two colleagues named Jordan

An assistant identifies a visitor's host.

01 • Assistant: Welcome. You mentioned Jordan; could I check the appointment reference in your invitation first?

02 • Visitor: It's V12, for ten o'clock. I don't remember whether Jordan works in facilities or sales.

03 • Assistant: V12 lists Jordan Chen in facilities. We also have a Jordan Patel, so I'm glad we checked.

04 • Visitor: Yes, the wrong Jordan wouldn't know why I brought these building plans with me.

05 • Assistant: I'll contact Jordan Chen now. Please wait here in reception while we arrange for you to be met.

06 • Visitor: Should I complete the visitor log now, or wait until Jordan confirms the meeting?

07 • Assistant: Please sign the visitor log here while I contact your host about the room.

08 • Visitor: There's Jordan on the phone. Can you ask whether the meeting is still in room four?

09 • Assistant: Jordan confirms room four and will collect you from reception in a moment.

10 • Visitor: Thank you. I'll wait by these chairs with my plans until Jordan arrives.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The visitor arrived at the old address

An assistant helps a caller at a former office location.

01 • Assistant: You said the reception desk is closed. Which street address appears on the invitation you're using?

02 • Visitor: Eighteen Harbor Street. I printed that invitation last month and came to the same entrance.

03 • Assistant: Our current meeting invitation gives twenty-four Harbor Street. Did the update reach your email?

04 • Visitor: I see the update now. I checked the time but missed the changed address.

05 • Assistant: I'm sorry the address change wasn't clearer. I'll tell your host you're coming from number eighteen.

06 • Visitor: I'm nearby but will be about ten minutes late. Could you tell the host before I walk over?

07 • Assistant: Yes. The host confirms that arrival is workable and will wait at the current reception.

08 • Visitor: Does the appointment reference remain V38, or did it change along with the address?

09 • Assistant: It remains V38. Use twenty-four Harbor Street and the main reception entrance shown in the update.

10 • Visitor: Twenty-four Harbor Street, V38. I'll be there in ten minutes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A companion was not on the visitor list

An assistant checks an additional visitor with the host.

01 • Assistant: The appointment lists one guest under V46, but two of you have arrived this morning.

02 • Visitor: My colleague came with me to discuss the samples. I forgot to mention them to the host.

03 • Assistant: I'll check with the host before arranging your colleague's access beyond reception.

04 • Visitor: Can we both wait in reception while you check with the host?

05 • Assistant: Certainly. May I tell the host your colleague's name and that they're joining the sample discussion?

06 • Visitor: Yes, it's Robin Ellis. There are no changes to the samples or the meeting purpose.

07 • Assistant: The host has confirmed Robin can join. We'll complete the separate visitor details for each of you.

08 • Visitor: Thank you. Should Robin use my badge, or will there be a separate one issued?

09 • Assistant: Robin needs a separate visitor badge after checking in; please keep your own.

10 • Visitor: Understood. We'll complete our own details and wait here for the host to collect us.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

Visitor Taylor arrives for a 10:00 meeting with Jordan. The office has two Jordans: Jordan Chen in facilities and Jordan Patel in sales. Reference V12 names Jordan Chen. Check the reference, contact the host, and explain the reception wait; the visitor is not cleared to enter other areas alone.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Visitor: Taylor, booking V12, meeting Jordan at ten; do not know Jordan's surname.

Second round: The visitor sees someone wearing a badge and asks to follow them upstairs. Keep the host-confirmation arrangement clear.

Scenario 2 | A visitor cannot stay for the delayed meeting

A 2:00 visitor can stay only until 2:30. The host is delayed until 2:20 and needs twenty minutes. The host can instead offer a video meeting tomorrow at nine.

Role A: Assistant: relay the timing conflict and the host's alternative.

Role B: Visitor: cannot stay past 2:30 but can attend tomorrow's video call.

Possible opening: If the meeting starts at twenty past, can we still finish by half past?

Success checks

- Calculate the ten-minute remaining window accurately.
- Avoid shortening the host's meeting by assumption.
- Confirm acceptance of tomorrow's alternative and requested invitation.

Add a complication: The visitor asks you to promise the host will cut the meeting in half.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying travel options and booking status

Explain price and cancellation flexibility using the supplied terms.

SITUATION

Two fictional rail quotes cover the same trip. A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable; B costs \$90 and permits a refund before departure with a \$10 deduction. The traveler's meeting is not confirmed. Purchasing approval is still required. Compare the supplied conditions without recommending financial or legal action.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

itinerary - A schedule of travel segments and related arrangements for a trip.

booking reference - An identifier used to locate a specific travel or accommodation reservation.

refundable fare - A fare allowing a refund under its stated conditions, which may include limits or charges.

expense claim - A request for reimbursement of eligible work expenses with the required supporting details.

Useful word combinations

check the fare conditions: read the rules attached to the quoted ticket

confirm the arrival station: verify the actual destination point

hold off on booking: wait before making a purchase or reservation

attach the supporting receipt: include the purchase record required for an expense request

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Compare the actual conditions, not a broad label

3. Notice the language

Refundable does not always mean every dollar comes back in every circumstance. Preserve the deadline and deduction attached to this fictional fare.

Both cover ___, but their conditions differ.

Under these terms, cancellation before ___ means ___.

Neither is booked; we still need ___.

Compare this wording: The ninety-dollar fare is fully refundable.

Clearer: The ninety-dollar fare allows a refund before departure with a ten-dollar deduction.

The wording preserves the actual limit rather than exaggerating flexibility.

4. Check the language

1. Traveler: Would all ninety dollars come back if I cancel in time?

Assistant: No, the quoted fare is refundable ___.

A. after every missed train

B. subject to a ten-dollar deduction

C. without any deduction

D. only after departure

2. Traveler: Have you bought either ticket?

Assistant: No, I have compared the quotes but ___.

A. haven't made a booking

B. had made both bookings

C. am confirming both payments

D. have completed the purchase

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A cheaper fare with less flexibility

An assistant compares two rail quotes with a traveler.

01 • Assistant: For this journey, it's seventy nonrefundable, or a ninety-dollar refundable fare with conditions.

02 • Traveler: My meeting might move. What does conditional mean for the ninety-dollar fare you've found?

03 • Assistant: The supplied terms allow a refund before departure with a ten-dollar deduction, not a full refund.

04 • Traveler: That could matter. Does the seventy-dollar fare have the same cancellation option at a lower price?

05 • Assistant: No, that quote is nonrefundable. I haven't booked either, and purchasing approval is still needed.

06 • Traveler: Please send both options to the approver with those conditions, not just the headline prices.

07 • Assistant: I will. Is the arrival station the same one listed on your meeting invitation?

08 • Traveler: Yes, Central Station. I can reach the venue from there, but the meeting date remains unconfirmed.

09 • Assistant: I'll hold the booking until both the meeting date and purchasing approval are confirmed.

10 • Traveler: Thanks. Please contact me when the date and approval are settled, before buying anything.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A hotel date changed but the train did not

An assistant checks a colleague's itinerary.

01 • Assistant: Your hotel starts Wednesday, but the itinerary still shows Tuesday's outbound train.

02 • Traveler: The meeting moved a day. I changed the hotel, then forgot to ask about the train.

03 • Assistant: Let's check the existing train booking reference and its conditions before discussing a change.

04 • Traveler: The reference is T82. Please don't buy another ticket automatically while the original is still active.

05 • Assistant: I won't. I'll ask the travel desk what changes are available under that booking.

06 • Traveler: Could you keep the return date unchanged? The final session still ends on Friday afternoon.

07 • Assistant: Yes. The request concerns the outbound date only, with Friday's return remaining as currently booked.

08 • Traveler: The desk can review that today. Can you send me the revised itinerary only after confirmation?

09 • Assistant: I'll mark Wednesday's outbound journey pending until the travel desk confirms the change.

10 • Traveler: Good. I'll use the current reference for the query and wait before assuming the journey has moved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A card statement is not the requested receipt

An assistant explains missing support for an expense claim.

01 • Assistant: Your expense claim includes the card statement, but the travel policy asks for the itemized hotel receipt.

02 • Traveler: I have a payment confirmation too. Does that show enough detail for this claim?

03 • Assistant: It shows payment, but not the room nights and separate items requested in this policy.

04 • Traveler: Then I need the hotel's itemized receipt. Can I ask them using my booking reference H39?

05 • Assistant: Yes. Quote H39 and the stay dates so they can locate the relevant document.

06 • Traveler: Please don't submit the claim as complete while I'm waiting for that missing receipt.

07 • Assistant: I'll keep it marked incomplete and note which document remains outstanding for the reviewer.

08 • Traveler: Could you check whether the train receipt is already included, so I don't request it again?

09 • Assistant: It is attached and readable. The hotel receipt is the only missing item identified here.

10 • Traveler: I'll ask the hotel for the receipt now and bring it back for checking.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying travel options and booking status

Two fictional rail quotes cover the same trip. A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable; B costs \$90 and permits a refund before departure with a \$10 deduction. The traveler's meeting is not confirmed. Purchasing approval is still required. Compare the supplied conditions without recommending financial or legal action.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Traveler: meeting might move; need a clear comparison and approval before any booking.

Second round: The traveler says refundable means no conditions. Read back the specific deduction and before-departure limit.

Scenario 2 | A conference venue has two nearby stations

The invitation names Riverside East station; an old itinerary names Riverside Central. Both are real destinations within this fictional exercise, and no ticket has been bought. The traveler needs the invitation's station.

Role A: Assistant: identify the destination mismatch before requesting a quote.

Role B: Traveler: confirm Riverside East and the conference date.

Possible opening: The station names are almost the same; does it matter which one is quoted?

Success checks

- Confirm Riverside East by name.
- Compare quotes for the same actual journey.
- Keep price separate from destination correctness.

Add a complication: A colleague says the cheaper quote must be correct.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

Negotiate task order using actual durations and agreed deadlines.

SITUATION

At 10:00 an assistant has a visitor list due at 10:30 and a room pack due at 11:00. Each needs thirty minutes. A manager requests a new twenty-minute spreadsheet check by 10:20. No colleague is free. Ask the manager to choose priorities or adjust a deadline; do not promise all three.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

deadline - The latest agreed time by which a task or response must be completed.

dependency - Something another task needs before it can proceed, such as a confirmed attendee list.

handover - An exchange passing current task status and outstanding work to another person.

coverage - An arrangement for another worker to handle specified duties during someone's absence.

Useful word combinations

agree the priority order: decide which task should come first

flag a dependency: identify the missing input holding up a task

hand over an open item: transfer an unfinished task with its current status

confirm coverage: check who will handle named duties during an absence

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Make the conflict specific enough to resolve

3. Notice the language

Describe the total workload and its timing, then ask the person with authority to choose. Don't quietly downgrade another person's deadline.

I have ___ due at ___, requiring ___.

Adding ___ means ___ will be delayed.

Which deadline can we revise with ___?

Compare this wording: I'll somehow fit it all in.

Clearer: The added twenty-minute check conflicts with the existing deadlines; which task should move?

The manager can make an informed choice rather than rely on an impossible promise.

4. Check the language

1. Manager: At ten, do my twenty-minute check first, then the thirty-minute visitor list due at ten-thirty.

Assistant: That means ____.

A. the visitor list will miss its current deadline

B. the visitor list will still meet its current deadline

C. the room pack can start earlier than planned

D. the spreadsheet check will follow the visitor list

2. Colleague: The room pack needs the final attendee list first.

Assistant: That list is a ____.

A. completed handover

B. replacement deadline

C. coverage agreement

D. dependency

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three deadlines cannot all stay the same

An assistant negotiates competing tasks with a manager.

01 • Assistant: Both original tasks take thirty minutes: visitor list by ten-thirty, room pack by eleven.

02 • Manager: Please do a twenty-minute spreadsheet check first, by ten-twenty. Can the other tasks still fit?

03 • Assistant: Not without delaying an existing deadline. No colleague is free; which commitment can we move?

04 • Manager: The visitor list must stay at ten-thirty. Could the room pack be finished a little later instead?

05 • Assistant: The training starts at eleven, so the trainer would need to agree to that delay.

06 • Manager: Keep both original deadlines. I'll accept the spreadsheet check at eleven-twenty, after the pack.

07 • Assistant: That gives each task the stated time. I'll tell you if a missing input changes the schedule.

08 • Manager: Please do. The spreadsheet can wait, but the visitor list must reach reception on time.

09 • Assistant: Visitor list first, room pack second, and your spreadsheet check by eleven-twenty.

10 • Manager: Agreed. I'll tell the person waiting for the check that I've accepted the revised time.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Coverage includes the phone, not every pending task

An assistant arranges lunch coverage.

01 • Assistant: Could you cover the reception phone from twelve to twelve-thirty while I take lunch?

02 • Colleague: Yes. Am I also taking over the supplier follow-up due at one, or only the phone?

03 • Assistant: Only the phone. I'll return before the one o'clock follow-up and keep responsibility for it.

04 • Colleague: Then please show me where the call-routing list is and which colleague handles urgent delivery questions.

05 • Assistant: The list is beside the phone. Facilities extension 214 handles delivery arrangements during that period.

06 • Colleague: I'll take messages and use that route if a delivery caller needs the team.

07 • Assistant: Thank you. There's a visitor expected at twelve-fifteen; their host knows to meet them here.

08 • Colleague: I can greet them and contact the host, but I won't change their room booking independently.

09 • Assistant: That's enough coverage. I'll be back at twelve-thirty and check any messages with you.

10 • Colleague: Fine. I'll keep the messages in the normal record and give you a short handover.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The missing list is holding up the room pack

An assistant gives a status update to a trainer.

01 • Assistant: The room pack is ready except for the final attendee list, which hasn't reached us yet.

02 • Trainer: I sent a draft yesterday with fourteen names. Can't you use that as the final list?

03 • Assistant: Yesterday's draft left two places unconfirmed. Has their attendance changed since then?

04 • Trainer: Those two have now accepted. I'll send the confirmed list of sixteen this morning.

05 • Assistant: Thank you. What time can you send it so I can prepare the correct number of packs?

06 • Trainer: By ten-fifteen. The session starts at eleven, and I need the packs delivered by ten-forty-five.

07 • Assistant: That works if the confirmed list arrives then. I'll prepare the unchanged materials while I wait.

08 • Trainer: Please avoid printing names from the draft if any corrections appear on the final version.

09 • Assistant: I will. The final list is the dependency; the other material can be prepared now.

10 • Trainer: I'll send the confirmed sixteen names by ten-fifteen and highlight the changed entries.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

At 10:00 an assistant has a visitor list due at 10:30 and a room pack due at 11:00. Each needs thirty minutes. A manager requests a new twenty-minute spreadsheet check by 10:20. No colleague is free. Ask the manager to choose priorities or adjust a deadline; do not promise all three.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Manager: visitor list must stay at 10:30; can move the spreadsheet check to 11:20 while keeping the pack at eleven.

Second round: The manager calls the extra task urgent without changing its duration. Ask which existing commitment should change.

Scenario 2 | A handover recipient is unavailable

The usual afternoon cover is absent. A callback to supplier D55 is due at four. The supervisor can assign Jamie, who is available from three. No reassignment has been confirmed.

Role A: Assistant: ask the supervisor to confirm a named replacement.

Role B: Supervisor: can assign Jamie and request explicit acceptance.

Possible opening: Who will take the four o'clock supplier callback now that our usual cover is absent?

Success checks

- Name D55 and the callback time.
- Ask for a specific owner rather than a broad group.
- Confirm Jamie's acceptance before treating coverage as settled.

Add a complication: A note saying 'afternoon team' is treated as enough.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Scheduling across calendars and time zones

Editing example: Do you mean three here, which is noon for the other office on that date?

The question identifies the missing time reference.

Check 1: D - both local times

A: That would describe different moments under the supplied time difference.

B: That also changes the intended local time for this office.

C: An unspecified time would leave the original ambiguity unresolved.

D: Correct. Both local times make the intended shared moment clear.

Check 2: C - a tentative hold

A: A reserved opening does not by itself confirm the meeting.

B: No reply does not establish that Morgan has declined.

C: Correct. The time is reserved temporarily while acceptance remains outstanding.

D: Morgan has not replied, so acceptance cannot be recorded.

Model response: When you say three o'clock, do you mean three in your office's time zone? On this date, that would be noon for the other office. Both calendars are open then, but I haven't sent an invitation. Please confirm the intended local time so I can label the meeting accurately.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

Editing example: I'll pass on your request for a callback before four; the team hasn't confirmed that time.

The caller's preference remains distinct from a promise.

Check 1: C - facilities at extension 214

A: A payments queue would misroute the stated delivery concern.

B: Invoice approval is not the subject of this call.

C: Correct. Facilities is responsible for delivery D18 in this case.

D: The caller explicitly excluded an invoice query.

Check 2: B - request

A: No appointment has been accepted by the recipient.

B: Correct. The time is requested but not confirmed.

C: No commitment to that time has been received.

D: The return call has not yet happened.

Model response: Could I confirm that your call concerns delivery D18 for facilities, rather than an invoice query for finance? I'll route the message to extension 214. Please confirm your preferred callback details. I'll include your request for a response before four, but I haven't confirmed the team's availability.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Preparing meetings and confirming action points

Editing example: Sam will obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase is approved.

The record states a checkable task and avoids inventing a decision.

Check 1: B - two quotes requested, purchase undecided

A: No replacement equipment has been delivered.

B: Correct. This preserves the quote task and the unresolved purchase decision.

C: No purchase approval was given in the meeting.

D: No supplier appointment was described or completed.

Check 2: A - by

A: Correct. 'By Thursday' means no later than Thursday and permits earlier delivery.

B: 'Until' describes a continuing action up to a time, not this completion deadline.

C: 'Since' normally marks a starting point continuing into a later period.

D: 'From' identifies a starting point, not the latest completion date.

Model response: We have ten minutes left, and the chair has prioritized the printer item. Sam, can you confirm you'll obtain two quotes by Thursday? I'll record that as the action, not as purchase approval. Can we move visitor signage to the next agenda and confirm whether anyone needs that discussed sooner?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Checking document versions and access

Editing example: Version three is current; I'll send its link and check your viewing access.

The recipient knows which file to use and what remains unresolved.

Check 1: A - access permission

A: Correct. Access denied indicates the recipient lacks the required permission.

B: The revision is current; it does not resolve denied viewing access.

C: No unsupported format message was reported in this case.

D: The reported problem concerns permission rather than attachment size.

Check 2: D - approved version three

A: Version two contains the incorrect reception-floor detail.

B: Download order does not establish the approved current revision.

C: The oldest saved copy may contain superseded information.

D: Correct. Version three is the current approved guide in this case.

Model response: I sent version two, which gives the wrong reception floor. I'm sorry for the confusion. Version three was approved this morning and is the current guide in the shared folder. I'll send its link and ask the document owner to resolve your viewing access before you rely on the guide.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Querying office supplies and delivery differences

Editing example: P44 lists twelve boxes, but the checked shipment contains ten; are two still due?

The supplier receives an identifiable discrepancy and a focused question.

Check 1: D - We've reported a short delivery; a backorder hasn't been confirmed

A: No backorder confirmation has been supplied in this case.

B: The note lists twelve but does not identify another shipment.

C: The physical count is ten, so it cannot confirm receipt of twelve.

D: Correct. The reported shortage is known; the supplier's status for the remaining two is not.

Check 2: C - internal request

A: No goods have been acknowledged as delivered.

B: An internal request does not establish invoice approval.

C: Correct. A requisition requests goods internally before required approval and ordering.

D: The scenario does not establish that a purchase order was issued.

Model response: Purchase order P44 lists twelve archive boxes, and the delivery note also lists twelve. We received ten in the checked shipment, leaving a difference of two. Could you confirm whether another package is due or whether this is a short delivery, and give us the next update time?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

Editing example: V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities; I'll contact that host before directing you further.

The visitor gets a confirmed receiving person and a clear waiting location.

Check 1: C - Jordan Chen in facilities

A: Availability does not change the named host for this visit.

B: Desk location does not identify the person responsible for V12.

C: Correct. V12 identifies Jordan Chen in facilities.

D: That is the other Jordan, not the V12 host.

Check 2: B - visitor badge

A: Delivery authorization concerns permission for goods, not this named visitor's identification.

B: Correct. The visitor badge identifies the guest under the visit arrangements.

C: An employee access card is not the guest's identification pass.

D: A parking permit concerns a vehicle, not the visitor's identification.

Model response: We have two colleagues named Jordan, so could I check your appointment reference? V12 lists Jordan Chen in facilities. I'll contact that host now. Please wait here in reception while we confirm the receiving arrangements; I'll update you as soon as Jordan responds.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Clarifying travel options and booking status

Editing example: The ninety-dollar fare allows a refund before departure with a ten-dollar deduction.

The wording preserves the actual limit rather than exaggerating flexibility.

Check 1: B - subject to a ten-dollar deduction

A: The terms do not promise refunds after missed departures.

B: Correct. That condition matches the supplied fare terms.

C: The quote explicitly includes a ten-dollar deduction.

D: The supplied refund condition applies before departure.

Check 2: A - haven't made a booking

A: Correct. Comparing quotes has not created a booking.

B: This says bookings were made, contrary to the case.

C: No payment confirmation is in progress here.

D: No purchase has been completed in the supplied facts.

Model response: Both quotes cover the same trip. A costs seventy dollars and is nonrefundable; B costs ninety and allows a refund before departure with ten dollars deducted. Your meeting is still unconfirmed, so that flexibility may matter. Neither option is booked, and purchasing approval is still needed before we proceed.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

Editing example: The added twenty-minute check conflicts with the existing deadlines; which task should move?

The manager can make an informed choice rather than rely on an impossible promise.

Check 1: A - the visitor list will miss its current deadline

A: Correct. The check plus list need fifty minutes, beyond the ten-thirty deadline.

B: Only ten minutes would remain for the thirty-minute list after the check.

C: Adding work before the list delays rather than advances the room pack.

D: The manager explicitly asked for the spreadsheet check first.

Check 2: D - dependency

A: A required input is not itself a completed transfer of responsibility.

B: The list is information, not a new completion time.

C: Coverage names who handles duties, not the input required here.

D: Correct. The pack depends on receiving that input.

Model response: I have the visitor list due at ten-thirty and the room pack at eleven, each needing thirty minutes. The new check adds twenty minutes before ten-twenty, so I can't complete all three by those times. Which should take priority, and which deadline can we revise with the person waiting for it?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All organizations, appointments, documents, prices, policies, and incidents are fictional English practice. This is not legal, financial, immigration, security, or records-retention advice. Follow the employer's actual purchasing, access, privacy, travel, and approval arrangements. Sample policies and delegated responsibilities apply only to the stated exercise.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Secretaries and Administrative Assistants

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/office-and-administrative-support/secretaries-and-administrative-assistants.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Secretaries and Administrative Assistants, Except Legal, Medical, and Executive

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/43-6014.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Office and Administrative Assistant English

Professional audience: Office assistants, administrative assistants, reception administrators, and team support staff

Scope: All organizations, appointments, documents, prices, policies, and incidents are fictional English practice. This is not legal, financial, immigration, security, or records-retention advice. Follow the employer's actual purchasing, access, privacy, travel, and approval arrangements. Sample policies and delegated responsibilities apply only to the stated exercise.

Lesson 01: Scheduling across calendars and time zones

Original fictional case: A colleague asks for a 3:00 meeting with another office. For this fictional date, 3:00 in the colleague's office equals noon at the other office. The request does not identify whose time is intended. Both calendars are open at that equivalent time; confirm the intended time before sending invitations.

Language workshop: Resolve the time reference before booking

Communication goal: Confirm whose clock a proposed meeting time refers to.

Language guidance: A calendar opening is not acceptance. State both local times for the supplied date and distinguish a hold from a confirmed meeting.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Do you mean ___ in ___ time? / On that date, it will be ___ for ___. / I've placed a hold; ___ is still unconfirmed.

Vocabulary: calendar invitation: An electronic request placing a proposed meeting in participants' calendars. / tentative hold: A temporary reservation of time that has not yet been fully confirmed. / time zone: A region's system of local clock time used when comparing meeting times across locations. / buffer time: Time left between appointments for preparation, travel, or overruns.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Colleague: mean three in your own office; can explain the supplied noon equivalent when asked.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: One participant calls the time lunchtime. Check their local time rather than treating the phrase as a new booking request.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: When you say three o'clock, do you mean three in your office's time zone? On this date, that would be noon for the other office. Both calendars are open then, but I haven't sent an invitation. Please confirm the intended local time so I can label the meeting accurately.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT

Choose a clear message

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach guided workplace message choices

1. Use only the supplied reference and create one short, realistic dialogue with professional role labels and exactly one missing word or phrase. Supply four distinct options labelled A-D. Ensure that exactly one option fits both the grammar and the stated facts. Do not request a draft, an essay, or any open-ended writing. Stop and wait for my choice.
2. Use plausible distractors based on word combinations, certainty, timing, responsibility, or register. Avoid obviously absurd options. Do not introduce an unverified diagnosis, approval, deadline, charge, or legal rule. If extra fictional facts are necessary, state them explicitly before asking the question.
3. After I choose, identify the correct option and explain briefly why each of the other three options does not fit this exchange. Quote the relevant case fact or wording. Invite me to read both roles aloud; do not claim to assess pronunciation from a typed response.
4. Offer another four-choice exchange that practices a different expression. Present only one question at a time, wait for my answer, and vary the correct letter. If more than one answer is defensible, acknowledge the ambiguity and replace the question rather than marking a reasonable choice wrong.
5. After four exchanges, recap two useful word combinations and one distinction I should revisit. Ask which supported scenario I want to rehearse next, then stop and wait.

END PROMPT